Mile Marker #4: My Academic Toolkit

Every Pathfinder needs the right tools: the ones that actually work for how you learn.

This Mile Marker is about what works for you, in your real life, this semester. Not what worked for a classmate, and not what a study guide says.

For in-person classes. Fill in this handout by hand, then upload a photo or scan to the Mile Marker #4 assignment in Blackboard. You can also type in the boxes and save it as a PDF. **Before you start,** try one study strategy. Questions 1 and 2 are about how it went.

NAME

DATE

QUESTION 1

The Strategy You Tried

"I studied more" isn't specific. "I tried reviewing my notes out loud the night before class" is.

A strong answer *Names one specific strategy, habit, or tool and gives a real reason you chose it.*

1. Name the study strategy, habit, or tool you focused on this week.

2. Explain why you chose it.

QUESTION 2

What You Noticed

Be honest about what happened, not what you hoped would happen.

A strong answer *Describes how you used it in a real class or task and at least one specific thing you noticed about your learning.*

1. Describe how you used it in a real class or task.

2. Describe one thing you noticed about your learning.

QUESTION 3

Your SMART Goal

Write one goal for keeping a study strategy or habit going for the rest of the semester. It doesn't need to be a perfect plan, just an honest one that fits where you are right now.

A strong answer *Covers all five parts, names a real class or goal, and includes a clear way to tell whether you followed through.*

1. Specific: What exactly will you do?

2. Measurable: How will you know you did it?

3. Achievable: Why is it realistic for your life right now?

4. Relevant: Why this habit, and which class or goal does it help?

5. Time-bound: When, and how often?

QUESTION 4

Your AI Use

Think about any AI tool you used this week, for this course or any other. If you didn't use AI at all, that's a complete answer. Just say so.

A strong answer *Says honestly where your AI use landed (or that you didn't use AI) and whether that was where you meant to land. Full credit doesn't depend on where you landed on the meter.*

1. Choose where your AI use landed on the AI Creep Meter. *(choose one)*

☐ Brainstorming ☐ Outlining ☐ Drafting ☐ Revising ☐ Rewriting ☐ Submitting

☐ I didn't use AI this week

2. Explain whether that was where you meant to land, or whether it shifted further than you planned. If you didn't use AI, write "No AI this week."